

Tao Louie Xu, MSc

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PhD applicant in the political economy of development to study the microfoundations of industrial policy & political settlements from an ideological change perspective. Graduated with the highest distinction from NUFE and a merit from Edinburgh. Proficient in NVivo, Stata, ArcMap, Python, and open to qualitative & quantitative methodologies, with industrial and academic experience across CITIC, Mazars, Deloitte, Duke Kunshan, NUFE, UoEdin, SUFE, Fudan, and several public organisations. Seeking more professional challenges in international research universities to apply my knowledge and a transferable skill set.

SKILLS & RESEARCH INTERESTS

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|---|---|--|
| ▪ Institutional Political Economy of Development and Change | ▪ Heterodox Economics | ▪ Critical Urban, International, and Global Development Studies |
| ▪ Industrial Policy & Development | ▪ Microfoundations of Industrial Policy and Political Settlements | ▪ Clientelism in Urban Industrialisation & Structural Transformation |
| ▪ Political Settlements Framework | ▪ Institutional & Ideological Change | |

QUALIFICATIONS & AWARDS

M.Sc. Development Studies (International Development, Merit) - The University of Edinburgh, Nov 2024

Dissertation Topic: The Road Not Taken? Industrial Policy and Political Settlements in China and Indonesia 1990–2022

Supervisor: Hazel Gray, Ph.D., Senior Lecturer in African Studies & International Development

Key Modules: Anthropology of International Development · Political Economy of Development · Resource Politics and Development · Development Institutions & Practices · Poverty and Governance in Africa · Research Design

B.Sc. Economics (Commercial Economics, 1st: 91.29) - Nanjing University of Finance & Economics, Jun 2023

Dissertation Topic: Towards Sustainable Prosperity? Policy Evaluation of Jiangsu Advanced Manufacturing Clusters

Supervisor: Yabei Hu, Ph.D., Professor of Industrial Economics

Key Modules: Microeconomics · Macroeconomics · Econometrics · International Economics · Regional Market and Interregional Trade · Regional & Urban Economics · Business Economics · Industrial Organisation · Economic History

Winter/Summer Schools, Workshops & Seminars

Research Methodology in Applied Economics, Adv - Nanjing Agricultural University, Aug 2023, 2025

AI in Economic Theory & Methodology, Adv - University of Chinese Academy of Sciences, Jul 2024, 2025

Advanced Modern Economics, Adv - Shanghai University of Finance and Economics, Jul 2025

Marxian Political Economy, Adv - Wuhan University, Jul 2023, 2024

Big Data Analytics in GISciences, Advanced - Nanjing Normal University, Aug 2023

International Business Management, Prof David French - UCLA & University of Saint Joseph, Jan 2022

Firm Innovation Strategy Seminar, Profs Xiaobo Wu & Wenwei Xu - Fudan Centre for Technovation Strategy, Dec 2025

Landlord State and Precarious Urban Agriculture in Accra, Prof Dzodzi Tsikata - Edinburgh CAS, Mar 2024

Political Economy of Extractivist Development in Ghana, Dr Gertrude Torvikey - Edinburgh CAS, Nov 2023

Skills, Courses & Certifications

Econometrics, Text Analytics & GISciences: Stata · NVivo · ArcMap · Python · VOSviewer · Matlab · CiteSpace

Communication & IT Literacy: (NCRE L2) Access · Excel · Publisher · Canva

Global Development Management, Seeing Institutions in Different Ways, Keynesian Economics - The Open University
 Korean Economic Development - Yonsei University · Local Economic Development - Erasmus University Rotterdam
 Understanding Research Methods - SOAS University of London · Game Theory - UBC and Stanford University
 Microeconomics, Economics of Health Care Delivery, Comparative Health Systems - University of Pennsylvania
 Health Systems Development, Epidemiology - University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill and Imperial College London
 New Structural Economics, Advanced Quantitative Social Research, Science of Logic - Peking University and CUF

Honours & Awards

Jiangsu Provincial Distinguished UG Dissertation Award 1st Class (77 1st-class works/over 732k graduates)	
Jiangsu Provincial Government Scholarship for Overseas Studies	NUFE Principal's Scholarship
NUFE Distinguished UG Dissertation Award (11/3956)	NUFE Honours Graduate (Summa Cum Laude)
NUFE Merit Scholarship for Academic Excellence (Dean's List)	NUFE Honours Student
NUFE Merit Scholarship for High Calibre (Best Performance Prize)	NNU Outstanding Student Award
WHU Outstanding Student & Distinguished Paper Award (19/~1300)	NAU Outstanding Student Award

Professional Memberships & Activities

Association for Social Economics · World Economics Association · Rethinking Economics

PUBLICATIONS

- "Towards Sustainable Prosperity? Policy Evaluation of Jiangsu Advanced Manufacturing Clusters," with Yabei Hu*, *Technology in Society*, 2024, 102583, honoured by Jiangsu Provincial Distinguished Dissertation Award

WORK IN PROGRESS

- "Recharged with Multilayered Innovation Systems: A Case of EV Charger Giant, StarCharge"
- "Building Connectivity for Inclusive Global Development: A Perspective from China and Global South," with Li Liu
- "Why Cities Backfire? High-Speed Railway New Town Planning and Urban Structural Change," with Yi Zhu*, 2025
- "When Polanyi Met Schumpeter: Social Trust and Entrepreneurship," with Weiwei Zhu, 2025, MPRA 123894, Under Review
- "Reinterpreting the Political Settlements Framework with Structuration Theory," 2024, SocArXiv nmvhq
- "The Road Not Taken? Industrial Policy and Political Settlements in China and Indonesia 1990–2022," 2024, supervised by Dr Hazel Gray
- "It Takes Three to Ceilidh: Pension System and Multidimensional Poverty Mitigation in China," with Yansong Wang*, and Cheng Yuan, 2024, arXiv 2411.02807, (2025 Apr) Birmingham Business School-Nanjing Audit University Institute of Economics International Conference on Ageing, Inequality, and Sustainable Development
- "Peasant Life in Changing China: Rural Pension System Reform and Social Insurance Participation," with Zhengyi Hu, advised by Dr Yongliang Wu, 2022, arXiv 2204.00785

REPORTS, PRESENTATIONS & BOOK REVIEWS

- "Endogenous Innovation of Firms: A Cross-layered Analytical Framework," with Li Liu, 2025, Fudan Development Institute Report December Series, Shanghai
- "Partnership-based Connectivity for Inclusive Global Development: Perspectives and Practices from China–Global South Agri-food Value Chains," with Li Liu, 2025, Fudan Development Institute–Pontificia Universidad Católica del Perú–Observer Research Foundation–South African BRICS Think Tank–Human Sciences Research Council, Dubai
- "Digital Social Innovation and Emerging Industries: A Case of China's NEV Industrial Policy Evolution," with Li Liu, 2025, Fudan Development Institute–Shanghai Technology Commission, Shanghai

- “China’s Endogenous Innovation in the Tech Cold War Era: From Integrated Strategy to Geopolitical Narrative,” with Li Liu, 2025, Fudan Development Institute–Hefei University of Technology, Shanghai
- “Gu Yanwu’s Neoclassical Confucianism and Entrepreneurship in Contemporary Kunshan, China,” with Xiaoyi Tao, 2025, Kunshan Federation of Humanities and Social Sciences Circles, Kunshan
- “Economic Growth, Poverty Mitigation, and Social Policy in our Neoliberal Era: A Polanyian Perspective,” 2024
- “Turbulence and Order in Economic Development: Economic Transformation in Tanzania and Vietnam by Hazel Gray,” 2024, Edinburgh
- “Belt of Productivity, Road to Equality: People First Infrastructure Development in Indonesia,” 2023, Edinburgh
- “Having People, Having Heart: Charity, Sustainable Development, and Problems of Dependence in Central Uganda by China Scherz,” 2023, Edinburgh
- “Common Prosperity and the Middle Class,” *WHU Proceedings of the Summer Institute on Marxian Economics*, 2023, 4, 1–5, Wuhan
- “The Theory of Economic Development by Joseph Schumpeter,” 2022, Nanjing
- “A Study of History by Arnold Toynbee,” 2021, Nanjing
- “Eudemonia and Freedom: Frontiers and Evolution of Employment Studies in China,” with Weiwei Zhu, advised by Prof Dr Wenwu Zhang, 2021, MPRA 112908, Nanjing
- “Survey on Local Pharmaceutical Specialty Stores: Retail Formats and Elements,” with Yukun Gu, Yibo Wang, Dapeng Zhu, Wei Li, Zhenyu Zhang, Jingxia Hou, and Yuhan Yang, advised by Prof Jinguo Tao, 2021, Nanjing
- “Mismatch and Dysfunction of the Ageing Economy: Digital Transformation in Silver-Hair Industry,” with Y. Gu, Y. Wang, and Q. Chen, *Journal of the Jiangsu Association for Commercial Economics*, 2021, 38, 1–9, Nanjing
- “Reshaping Silver-Hair Industry with New Retailing: A SWOT-Based Strategy,” *Journal of the China Federation of Logistics*, 2021, 28, 82–85, Nanjing
- “Survey on the Ageing Society in Rural Guannan: Consumption, Social Security, and Manufacturing for Silver-Hair Economy,” with Yukun Gu, and Yibo Wang, advised by Dr Qifei Chen, 2020, Guannan & Nanjing

RESEARCH & PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Fudan University (Shanghai)	2025 – Present
Co-Investigator - Fudan Development Institute and Hefei University of Technology	2025 – Present
▪ Worked on project-oriented research, e.g. ‘<i>Strategic Optimisation of Global Supply Chain Engagement with Development Zones in China’s Yangtze Economic Belt</i>’ advised by Dr Li Liu, on 5 assigned projects ▪ Independently drafted the Shanghai Key Think-Tank Project Proposal ‘<i>Tech Lead Firm Growth and Gradient-Heterogeneous Policy Toolkit in GVCs Governance</i>’ with Dr Liu for Shanghai Commission on Technology ▪ Reviewed cross-disciplinary literature spanning business life cycle, entrepreneurship, evolutionary innovation & industrial policy, authored 2 full reports (30,000+ words) ▪ Summarised a list of pundits in GVCs and supply chain management for project advisory committee ▪ Conducted a brief review of 20 papers on green agricultural transformation and sustainable rural livelihoods ▪ Engaged in Shanghai Forum 2025, reflected on talks by Keun Lee, Takehiko Nakao, Woo Wing Thye, and Michael Levitt on innovation strategy and global techno-nationalist policy change ▪ Drafted all the sections of a project-based work ‘Endogenous Innovation in the Tech Cold War Era’ ▪ Interpreted the dynamic capabilities of endogenous innovation to sense techno-nationalism, seize the market-technology change, and reconfigure resources through technology exploration, market exploitation & ecosystem orchestration under positive externalities of institutional complementarity ▪ Conducted case-based studies and a historical framing of China’s BRI agri-food engagements, compiling evidence from open data, reports, and news into an inclusive global development schema to compare BRI partnership modes and governance structures	

- Authored a 12,000-word working paper 'Partnership-based Connectivity for Inclusive Global Development', integrating connectivity into institutional design of inclusive GVCs across Asia, Africa, and Latin America
- Drafted 'Rethinking Connectivity' sections for think-tank roundtable discussions, providing policy-relevant perspectives on logistical bottlenecks, financial innovations, and geopolitical choke-points

Research Associate - Fudan Development Institute and Shanghai Technology Commission 2025

- Worked on the 15th Shanghai Government Consultation Research Awarded Project '*Digital Social Innovation and Emerging Industries*', with my subproject focus on new energy vehicle industry
- Articulated the structure of digital social innovation, its conceptual boundaries, actor subjects, objects, networked ecosystems, agendas, and gaps in social-commercial identity duality & techno-determinism
- Comparatively analysed the industrial change of automotive manufacturing in China, Japan, South Korea, Germany & US, and attributed China's to policy experimentation & clustered innovation
- Mapped China's NEV industrial policy trajectory since the 1990s, marked the shift from R&D incentives (tax credits & grants), public procurements, consumer subsidies towards market competition, full-chain industrial coordination & charging infrastructure provision, and drafted policy reports plus supplementary appendices
- Stylised facts and proposed recommendations on foresight social governance of industrial ecosystems, particularly regulatory gaps in flexible employment, social security, tax compliance, and labour rights

Shanghai University of Finance & Economics (Shanghai) 2024 – Present

Research Assistant - School of Public Economics & Administration 2024 – Present

- Reviewed the related work on high-speed railway and structural change, particularly on agglomeration economies, network-spillover effects of diffusion & the core-periphery framework, studied City Economics by O'Flaherty and Handbook of Regional & Urban Economics by Duranton, Henderson, Thisse, and Cheshire
- Advised on 'Impact of High-Speed Railway New Town Construction on Land Prices' with Prof Dr Yi Zhu
- Employed the DiD approach, illustrated that HSR town planning in Yangtze Delta cities inhibits the average unit labour productivity of tertiarisation in hub cities but facilitates industrialisation in non-hub ones
- Examined the siphoning of the services in East China that labour & economic activities over-concentrate in core cities and industrial out-diffusion from hub cities enhancing secondary output of non-core areas
- Drafted 'Why Cities Backfire? High-Speed Railway New Town Planning and Urban Structural Change'

Peer Advisor - College of Business 2024

- Advised on a Master's dissertation 'Impact of Regional Trade Agreements on Export Resilience' supervised by Prof Dr Linke Zhu, mentored in research design and writing

Peer Advisor - Nanjing University Department of Finance (Nanjing) 2023 – 2025

- Mentored MPhil students in new structural economics, advised on economics causal inference & Bartik-IV
- Facilitated collaboration between students and PIs from Tsinghua PBC School of Finance & Peking Guanghua School of Management, supported studies on political trust in govt, SOE reform, and economic insecurity

Nanjing University of Finance & Economics (Nanjing) 2019 – 2024

Co-Investigator & Research Associate - School of International Economics & Business 2022 – 2024

- Worked on National Social Science Fund of China Programme '*Optimisation of Industrial Ecosystems for Advanced Manufacturing Clusters Based on Producer Services*' supervised by Prof Dr Yabei Hu
- Selected, compiled, and perused the publicly available policy documents issued by corresponding functional departments of the Jiangsu government, qualitatively summarised the relevance of the gist
- Deployed a mixed methodology by a triple analytical framework, scrutinised policy themes, instruments & controls through textual mining and PMC index modelling with a dataset of 52 official documents

- Independently conducted data collection, visualisation, drafting & submission
- Produced original research paper ‘Towards Sustainable Prosperity? Policy Evaluation of Jiangsu Advanced Manufacturing Clusters’ published in *Technology in Society*, honoured by Provincial Distinguished Award

Co-Investigator & Coordinator - School of International Economics & Business 2021 – 2022

- Worked on National ‘Culture, Science & Health to Rural China’ Programme ‘*Cultural Heritage and Industrial Organisation in Less-Developed Areas*’ with Weiwei Zhu, honoured by National Excellent Award, Provincial Special Award, and NUFE Best Report Award 1st Class
- Cooperated with the Shuyang government, conducted modern history investigation to organise specialised educational lecture series tailored to regional cultural endowments
- Introduced media campaigns across WeChat, Tiktok & Weibo for more visibility and accessibility of cultural heritage, integrate public participation into cultural preservation, tourism & economic development

Team Leader - Chinese Society for Optimisation & Economic Mathematics 2021

- Worked on ‘MathorCup’ Mathematical Contest in Modelling with Yansong Wang and Yukun Gu

Lead Investigator - School of International Economics & Business 2020 – 2021

- Initiated ‘*Reshaping Silver-Hair Industry with New Retailing: A Story of China*’ with Dr Qifei Chen
- Led the project from inception to completion, not limited to fundraising, recruitment, duty allocation, and resource coordination to ensure timely delivery of research goals
- Managed online surveys targeting younger individuals, adopted an intergenerational perspective to analyse the influence of younger generations on the familiarity of older adults with smart devices & online shopping
- Reviewed the literature on ‘new retailing’ in the ‘silver-hair economy’, investigated market challenges in an ageing society, organised fieldwork in Guannan, interviewed older adults face-to-face to capture their very nuanced demands, consumption behaviour & digital technology adoption
- Identified the supply-demand mismatch in the silver-hair industry, proposed actionable strategy of big data in e-commerce logistics for rural & urban fringe areas, recommended by Tibet Chief Secretary Chunlai Zhou
- Published 2 reports ‘Reshaping Silver-Hair Industry with New Retailing’ & ‘Mismatch and Dysfunction of the Ageing Economy’, drafted 1 working paper ‘Rural Pension System Reform and Social Insurance Participation’ with feedback from a Bangkok-based World Bank economist

Student Assistant - NUFE Admissions Committee 2019 – 2021

Research Assistant - School of Business Administration 2020

- Worked on Jiangsu Administration for Market Regulation Programme ‘*Customer Satisfaction Evaluation of Tertiary Sector*’, ensured public participation of online surveys and collected data

Coordinator Assistant (Intern) - Duke Kunshan University Office of Student Affairs (Kunshan) 2023

- Facilitated liaison among students, faculty & leadership, handled administrative operations of event logistics, copyright license agreements, reimbursements, bilingual brochure & yearbook editions, and other duties
- Supported Campus Engagement student worker recruitment & training, interviewed for FYSAC Chairs (14), Orientation Leaders (107) & Commencement Volunteers (97), coordinated events, visualised survey data

Advisor Assistant (Intern) - Deloitte Division of Tax (Suzhou) 2021

- Co-drafted a 42-page report with my focus on fixed assets, intangible assets, tax credits, inventories & cross-border intra-group financing, translated 3 appendices, and selected 8/517 CUP comparables with TP Catalyst
- Advised on tax incentives & industrial layouts for foreign-invested manufacturers in Yangtze Delta and liaised with Xiamen SAFE Bureau & investment promotion agencies on intra-group capital reallocation accounting

Audit Assistant (Intern) - Mazars Division of Audit (Suzhou) 2021

- Assisted with annual audits of Xiangcheng collective assets and Kunshan Hi-Tech Group, with my focus on P&L statement, balance sheet, large transaction, and state-owned asset confirmation
- Drafted 31 report sections and independently produced 7 audit working papers

Consultant Assistant (Intern) - CITIC Division of Wealth Management (Kunshan) 2020

Research Assistant - Administration for Market Regulation & Bureau of Finance (Kunshan) 2018 – 2020

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Language Proficiency

Fluent in English (IELTS Academic C1) and Mandarin with a good understanding of Wu and Literary Chinese

Peer Review

PLoS One · Heliyon · Journal of Infrastructure Policy and Development · World Development Sustainability · Journal of Chinese Governance

Referee List

Hazel Gray, PhD (SOAS Department of Economics)
Senior Lecturer
School of Social and Political Science
The University of Edinburgh
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Yi Zhu, PhD (MIT Department of Urban Studies & Planning)
Associate Professor
School of Public Economics and Administration
Shanghai University of Finance and Economics
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